PassFrame
TUITION

The Old Clock

Year 4 — 11+ Lesson Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Poetry

Extract (poem) — read it carefully before answering

In the hallway, tall and grand,
the old clock keeps its steady stand,
its golden hands that never rest,
tick-tocking on without a guest.

It watched my father, small and young,
when nursery rhymes were freshly sung;
it watched my mother learn to ride
her first bicycle, wobbly-wide.

It chimes each hour, deep and slow,
a sound I've always loved to know,
a patient voice that never shouts,
that simply counts the time, and doubts.

Some nights I sit upon the stair
and listen to it, standing there,
and wonder what it might have seen
in all the years it's stood between.

One day, perhaps, my children too
will hear its tick, so soft and true,
and know, as I have come to know,
that some old things are loath to go.

Questions

20 min · 12 questions

1. Where in the house does the old clock stand?

2. Name two family members the clock is said to have "watched" when they were young.

3. Underline the line that tells you the clock's sound happens every hour.

4. Underline 2 examples of personification in the poem.

5. What does "patient" suggest about the way the poet describes the clock's chime?

6. True or false: the poet dislikes the sound of the clock.

7. Why do you think the poet describes the clock as having "watched" family members, rather than simply saying it was present?

8. What does the poet do on some nights, according to the fourth verse?

9. In your own words, explain what the poet hopes will happen in the future, based on the final verse.

10. What does the phrase "some old things are loath to go" suggest about how the poet feels about the clock?

11. Why do you think the poet chose a clock, rather than another object, to write about family memories?

12. Do you have an object in your own home that reminds you of your family's history? Describe it in one or two sentences.